CHARACTER BOOKLET · No. 18

Arden *Fairweather*

THE NEIGHBOR NEXT DOOR

"You don't gossip. You simply share information early."



FOR YOUR EYES ONLY

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 9+ PLAYERS

WHAT TO WEAR

Dress style: a floral tea dress, a cardigan and opera glasses on a ribbon.

Suit style: pressed slacks, a sweater vest, a bow tie and the same opera glasses.

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Green bean casserole

Store-bought is fine. Bring it in a dish you love and set it by your table tent.

How this booklet works

Before guests arrive: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Appetizers · Round 1: when the host starts Round 1, open page 3.

The Main Course · Round 2: the lower half of page 3.

Pie · Round 3: page 4. Then everyone votes over coffee.

Accusation over coffee: fill in your ballot. Then the truth is read aloud.

Printing? Single-sided, please, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE GATHERING

The tenth annual Friendsgiving at Juniper Barn. Before the meal, cooking-show star Marigold "Goldie" Ashby tasted the first spoonful of gravy from her antique silver gravy boat, said she felt tired, settled into the rocking chair and never woke up. Every guest brought a dish. Every guest had a reason.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

Your Secret Page

You are innocent.

You did not harm Goldie. You may still have something to hide.

If you are not in the game, nothing breaks: the case is fully solvable without this booklet.

Your story and your secret

Goldie's TV crew kept parking on your lawn, and on the show Goldie once called your green bean casserole "a cry for help." You wrote a sharp letter to the TV station. You were also away from the barn for almost half an hour before dinner. You never hurt anyone.

Where you were (your alibi)

- 5:30: walked home next door to fetch your casserole, forgotten in your own oven.
- 5:30–5:55: at home, rescuing the casserole.
- About 5:56: walked back up the front lane and in the front door. The porch was empty by then.
- 6:00: in the hall for the first taste.

Your goal

Clear your name, share what you know and enjoy every scrap of gossip.

If someone asks you…

"Where were you before six?" → "At home rescuing my casserole. I came in the front door at about 5:56."

"Did you dislike Goldie?" → "She called my casserole a cry for help. Ask me in Round 3."

"What do you know about the gravy boat?" → "It's worth a small fortune, and Jules inherits it."

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

PLAYING TIP

Stay in character and read your Share lines aloud when a round opens. Write down every time you hear on your Detective Notes: someone's story will not match the clock. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet says to share it, but never lie about the evidence.

Appetizers • *Round 1*

ROUND 1 · WAIT FOR THE HOST

Read only when the host starts Round 1.

Share

- You live next door and have come to all ten Friendsgivings.
- You saw Goldie's car arrive at about 4:10, loaded with her gravy pot and the silver boat in a padded case.

KEEP QUIET FOR NOW · Your letter to the TV station.

Ask

- **Jules:** "How is the family taking Goldie's big news?"
- **Quinn:** "Is your cider mill doing well these days?"

Your mission

Share one (harmless) piece of "neighborhood news" with three different guests.

NOTES

✂ CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE HOST

The Main Course • *Round 2*

ROUND 2 · WAIT FOR THE HOST

Read only when the host starts Round 2.

Share

- Last week Goldie had the silver gravy boat valued at the antiques shop in town. It is worth a small fortune, and Jules inherits it.
- From 5:30 to 5:55 you were at home next door rescuing your casserole; you came back through the front door at about 5:56.

Ask

- **Jules:** "Did you know what the gravy boat is worth?"
- **Casey:** "Was anyone in the front lot when you were filming?"

Your mission

Use your opera glasses (real or pretend) to "observe" the room, then report one suspicious thing.

NOTES

Pie • *Round 3*

Read only when the host starts Round 3.

Share

- Your secret: Goldie mocked your casserole on TV and her crew parked on your lawn. You wrote an angry letter. That's all.
- When you came up the front lane at about 5:56, every car in the front lot was dark.

Ask

- **Morgan:** "Which car in the front lot is yours?"
- **Sage:** "Who taught you to make pie?"

Your mission

Announce the "neighborhood verdict": your top suspect, with one reason.

Who's who (public info · optional characters may not be playing)

10 Avery Quill
Barn owner & this year's host · *Roasted pumpkin soup*

11 Sage Montrose
Three-time pie contest champion · *Maple pecan pie*

12 Quinn Delacroix
Owner of Delacroix Cider Mill · *Hot spiced apple cider*

13 Morgan Feld
Cookbook editor · *Cranberry sauce*

14 Casey Thornbury
Producer of Supper with Goldie · *Mushroom stuffing*

15 Jules Carraway
Goldie's cousin · *Cheesy scalloped potatoes*

16 Harper Lindqvist (OPT.)
Farmers' market grower · *Roasted root vegetables*

17 Skyler Bontempo (OPT.)
Food truck owner · *Cornbread*

18 Arden Fairweather (OPT.)
The neighbor next door · *Green bean casserole*

19 Indigo Pike (OPT.)
Turkey farmer · *Roast turkey*

20 Charlie Okonjo (OPT.)
Cheese shop owner · *Autumn cheese board*

21 Wren Abernathy (OPT.)
Goldie's old roommate · *Homemade dinner rolls*

NOTES